

WHO THE PLATFORM IS FOR

Kumbh Setu — Role Personas

Three people, one connected loop: a pilgrim who needs help, a volunteer who gives it, and an operator who has to see the whole ground at once. Each persona below is a composite built from the Kumbhathon Personas document and the Tower 4 problem statements — used to design and to demo, not a real individual.

The loop they share

PILGRIM Raises a need — SOS, a question, a lost family member, a language gap.
VOLUNTEER Understands, communicates, acts, and reports what they see — with Kumbh Setu AI.
OPERATOR Sees the aggregate, separates signal from noise, dispatches, and keeps the audit trail.

Everything a persona touches in the tables ahead is a real screen or action in the prototype. Data is synthetic and labelled
SIMULATION MODE.



PERSONA 1 · THE PILGRIM

Lakshmi Iyer

58 · retired schoolteacher · Madurai, Tamil Nadu · first Simhastha Kumbh

TRAVELLING WITH Her 82-year-old mother, who tires quickly and uses a walking stick	LANGUAGES Tamil (fluent) · தமிழ் · a little English · no Hindi or Marathi
PHONE A mid-range Android; data patchy near the ghats; comfortable with WhatsApp, not much else	ON SITE Ghat 4 / Trimbakeshwar temple perimeter on a high-density bathing day
ROLE IN THE LOOP Raises the need — and is the person a volunteer's Setu translates for	

Context

Lakshmi has planned this trip for two years. She is devout, careful, and used to being the organised one — but she has never been in a crowd this size, cannot read the Marathi and Hindi signage, and is anxious about her mother in the press of people. She will not “bother” an official unless something is really wrong.

What they need (goals)

- Find the nearest toilet, water point and shade for her mother — quickly, without walking the wrong way
- Use the priority lane for elderly pilgrims, if she can find out where it is
- Get help from a volunteer even though they don't share a language
- Know if her ghat is dangerously crowded and whether there is a calmer alternative
- If someone in her group goes missing, start a proper search — not just panic

A day in their Kumbh

They reach the ghat approach mid-morning as the crowd thickens. Her mother needs a toilet, then somewhere to sit in shade, then water. Lakshmi cannot tell which lane is for elderly pilgrims. Later, turning around for a moment, she loses sight of her cousin's teenage son who was walking with them. Her Tamil questions get blank looks from the volunteers around her.

What frustrates them today

- Signage and announcements are in languages she cannot read or follow
- She doesn't know which volunteer to approach, or whether they can help
- Asking for directions produces vague pointing; she ends up in denser crowd
- A lost-person situation feels hopeless — who does she even tell, and how?
- Patchy data means an app that only works online is no use at the moment she needs it

How Kumbh Setu helps

They do / feel	In Kumbh Setu
Opens the Pilgrim app, needs a toilet / water / shade	Home screen map with facilities and a live crowd band for her zone; nearest facilities listed with status
Doesn't share a language with the volunteer helping her	The volunteer's Kumbh Setu AI runs live translation — she speaks Tamil, the volunteer hears it, and hears the reply back
Her cousin's son is missing	One confirmed tap raises it; the volunteer's Setu opens a structured missing-person case that the control room works against found-person reports
Something is wrong and she needs help now	SOS in one confirmed tap — location and situation reach the nearest volunteer and the control room; a degraded-network fallback still tries

“I don't need someone to solve everything. I need one person who can understand me and tell me where to go.”

What success looks like: Lakshmi gets her mother to a toilet and shade within minutes, is escorted via the priority lane, and — when the boy is missing — has a case number and a volunteer staying with her within the hour, not a shrug.



PERSONA 2 · THE VOLUNTEER (SEVAK)

Mahesh Joshi

24 · final-year engineering student · Nashik · volunteer ID V-218, Ghat 4

SHIFT 14:00–18:00 on the Trimbakeshwar temple perimeter (Zone Z04)	TRAINED IN Basic first aid and crowd marshalling; one briefing, a lot to remember
LANGUAGES Marathi · मराठी · English — not Tamil, Telugu or Bengali	PHONE His own Android, one hand free at best, often walking, often noisy
ROLE IN THE LOOP Understands → communicates → acts → reports — with Kumbh Setu AI	

Context

Mahesh is capable and willing but stretched. In one hour he is asked for directions in four languages, sees a barricade come loose, is flagged down for a person who feels faint, and is told a water point has run dry. He cannot know every answer, speak every language, remember every procedure, or stop to fill in a form for each thing he sees.

What they need (goals)

- Know what to do — the right first steps for a faint, a lost child, crowd pressure — without carrying a manual
- Communicate with any pilgrim regardless of language
- Report what he sees in seconds, with location and time attached, not on a clipboard
- See only his own tasks and act on them cleanly: accept, navigate, arrive, resolve
- Escalate the moment something is beyond him — and have the control room actually see it

A day in their Kumbh

He opens Kumbh Setu AI on /field; it greets him with his zone and a live status line. A Tamil-speaking pilgrim approaches — he says “help me talk to a pilgrim” and now has a two-way translator. Later he photographs a damaged barricade, says one line, and Setu turns it into a structured report. Near shift-end he reports a dry water point with a headcount; minutes later a task comes back to him to re-check it.

What frustrates them today

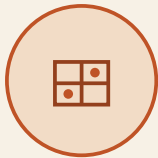
- Language barriers stall him several times an hour
- He half-remembers procedures and second-guesses himself under stress
- Reporting an issue properly means finding a supervisor or a form — so small things go unreported
- He can’t tell if the thing he just saw is also being seen by five other volunteers or just him
- Typing on a phone while standing in a moving crowd is close to impossible

How Kumbh Setu helps

They do / feel	In Kumbh Setu
Asks “nearest medical camp”, “what’s in my zone”, “what do I do if someone faints?”	Voice or text — a grounded answer from live facility / zone data, or the SOP as a numbered checklist, always with the source shown
Needs to talk to a Tamil / Hindi / Marathi pilgrim	“Help me talk to a pilgrim” → name the language → live two-way translation, each turn playable aloud
Sees a hazard — loose barricade, dry water point, overflow	Camera button + one spoken line → Setu structures category / severity / people affected / GPS / photo → he confirms and it’s filed
Situation exceeds him	“Raise an incident” / Escalate — a confirm card, then it’s on the control-room map with the nearest responder paged
Manages his own work	“My tasks” → Accept → “mark arrived” → “mark resolved” (resolve asks to confirm); every step logged

“I don’t want an app that answers questions. I want one that helps me actually do the job — and remembers the parts I can’t.”

What success looks like: Mahesh handles more situations per shift with less doubt; nothing he sees goes unreported; and the control room gets his observations as structured, located, time-stamped signals instead of a story he tells his supervisor later.



PERSONA 3 · THE CONTROL-ROOM OPERATOR

Sunita Deshpande

41 · operations officer, event authority · 15 years in civic emergency coordination

SEAT The control room — desktop, big screen, radio; covers several zones at once	ANSWERS TO The incident commander and, after the event, an audit
TOOLS TODAY Radio chatter, a wall map, three or four spreadsheets, phone calls	PRESSURE Prevent the small thing from becoming the headline; never over- or under-react
ROLE IN THE LOOP Sees the aggregate, separates signal from noise, dispatches, keeps the record	

Context

Sunita has run enough events to distrust both panic and complacency. Her problem is not lack of information — it is that the information is scattered, unverifiable, and arrives as anecdotes. She needs one picture, an early warning she can trust, and a record that will stand up afterwards. She will not act on a single unconfirmed report, and she will not ignore seven of them.

What they need (goals)

- One live operational picture — zones, crowd, incidents, volunteers, field reports — not five spreadsheets
- Early warning she can defend: several weak signals aggregated, with a visible confidence and its inputs
- Fast, skill- and language-aware dispatch, and the ability to promote a signal into an incident
- A complete, timestamped audit trail of every decision and every AI action

A day in their Kumbh

SOS and field reports land on her screen as they happen. A few volunteers report low water in one sector; Kumbh Pulse raises an emerging signal whose confidence climbs as more reports corroborate. She checks the resource feed, promotes it to an incident, and dispatches the nearest qualified volunteer — who accepts, arrives and resolves, each step appearing on her timeline.

What frustrates them today

- Reports arrive as radio anecdotes — no location, no time, no way to tell one report from ten
- No early-warning layer; she often learns of a build-up when it is already a problem
- Dispatch is manual and proximity-only — the nearest volunteer, not the right one
- Reconstructing “who knew what when” after the event means stitching logs together by hand

How Kumbh Setu helps

They do / feel	In Kumbh Setu
Wants the whole ground at a glance	Live Operations — map (abstract or real GIS), active incidents, volunteer roster, top-risk zone Pulse panel
Needs early warning she can trust	Kumbh Pulse: explainable 0–100 risk with contributor bars + Emerging Signals from aggregated field reports, confidence rising with corroboration
Gets a stream of field observations and must decide which to act on	Field Reports view — every report with category, severity, GPS, photo and a verification status (unverified → corroborated → verified); Promote to incident → skill- and language-aware dispatch of the nearest fit volunteer
Needs to guide pilgrims	Advisories — publish a zone or event-wide Notice / Advisory / Police Warning; live on every pilgrim phone in scope
Has to answer for it later	Event Log — every material transition and every Setu action, actor and timestamp, in one exportable trail

“Give me one screen, a warning I can defend to the commander, and a log I can hand to the inquiry. The rest is my job.”

What success looks like: Sunita spots the water-shortage build-up while it is still an inconvenience, dispatches once, and closes the loop — with a defensible confidence figure at the moment of decision and a complete audit trail at the end of the day.